

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 539

By Roberts

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Charlie Kirk.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the untimely death of Charlie Kirk, an important voice in the conservative movement and a close ally of President Donald Trump; and

WHEREAS, Charles James Kirk was the chief executive officer and founder of Turning Point USA (TPUSA), a conservative student organization that grew quickly after its inception in 2012, with Mr. Kirk expanding the organization's influence while raising millions in donations; and

WHEREAS, Charlie Kirk was a major figure and voice within the young conservative movement who argued for a new conservatism that advocated for freedom of speech; he had amassed millions of followers across his various social media platforms, and his daily three-hour radio talk show, *The Charlie Kirk Show*, was downloaded between 500,000 and 750,000 times each day in 2024; and

WHEREAS, a gifted orator and debater, Mr. Kirk had recently launched "The American Comeback Tour," a national college tour, in which he engaged with students through political debate to spread the conservative message to younger generations; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Kirk regularly appeared on conservative outlets, and he addressed such major political conferences as the 2024 Republican National Convention and the 2022 Conservative Political Action Conference; and

WHEREAS, Charlie Kirk is survived by his wife, Erika Frantzve, and two children; and

WHEREAS, Charlie Kirk was an outstanding individual, a devoted family man, and a pillar of the American conservative movement; his passing leaves a void in our country that will not be easily filled; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that the members of this General Assembly honor the memory of Charlie Kirk, reflecting fondly upon his life of purpose, his commitment to others, and his excellence as a conservative activist, podcaster, public servant, family man, and human being.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and extend our condolences to Mr. Kirk's family and many friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.